LESSON 9

# The Surprise

From Haydn's "Surprise" Symphony: a quiet tune, played again even quieter… then a loud chord to wake everyone up.

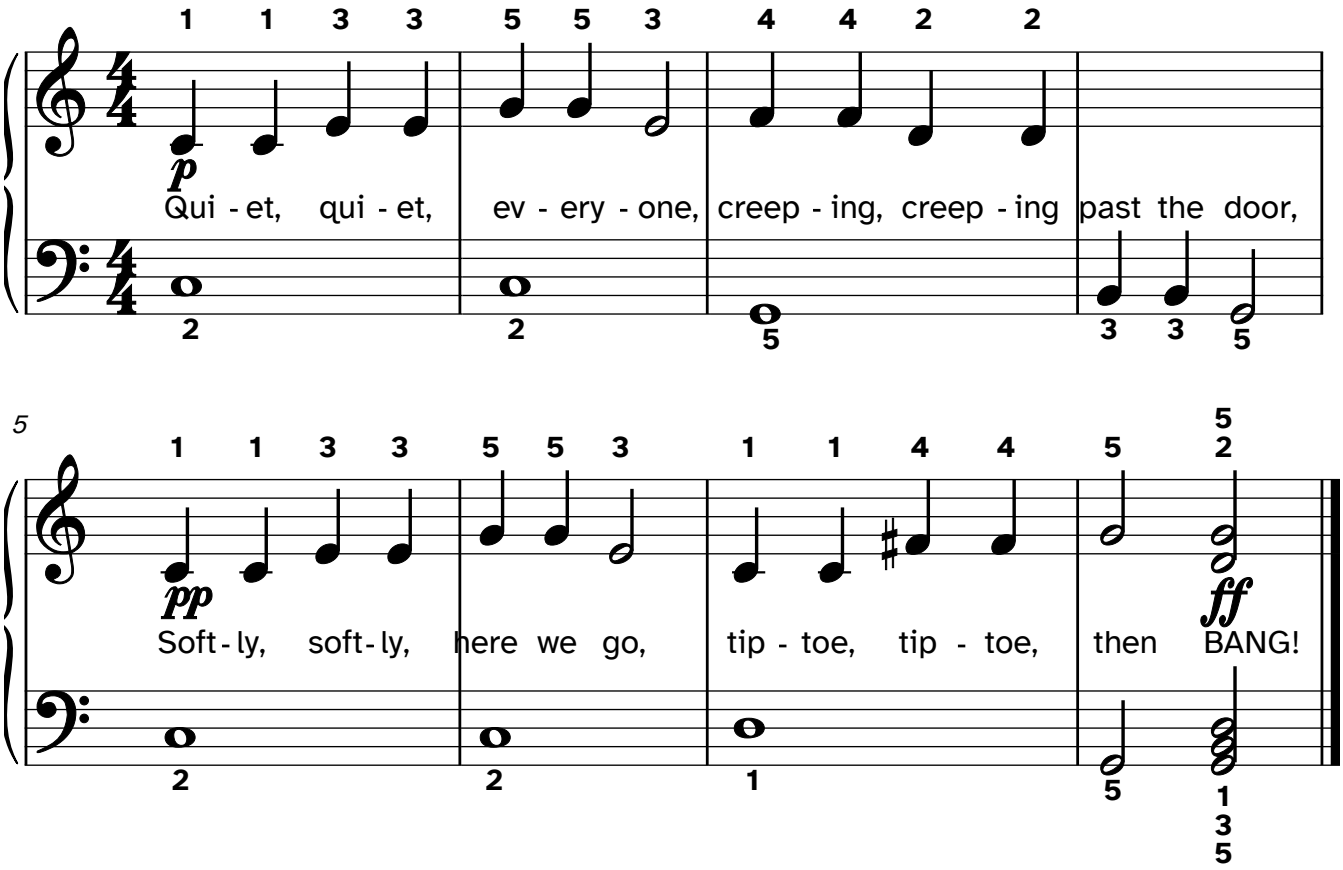
IN THIS SONG **the left hand answers low** **F sharp: a black key** **p and ff: soft and BANG**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

## 1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing. Sing it soft, then very soft… then BANG! Then play it: the left hand answers in bar 4.

**Right hand:** the C position; 4 moves up to F♯. **Left hand:** a new place, the G position: 5 on the low G, 1 on D. It plays the roots, and answers *past the door* down low.



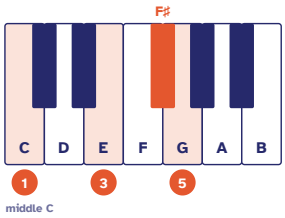

THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **The surprise:** Haydn wrote it for listeners who dozed off. Play the second half as softly as a whisper… then BANG: a G chord with both hands!

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Played the soft and the very soft** ☐ **Made the BANG**

# 2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · C POSITION, 4 ON F♯




**NEW IN THIS SONG**

**F♯:** the black key just right of F, F's best friend. **p** soft, **pp** very soft, **ff** very loud. **The G position** for the left hand: 5 on low G.

## THE RHYTHM

Say it in time, then clap and count: clap on coral, hold on grey, lift on a rest.

**THE TIME**

4/4

**Top 4:** four beats in every bar.

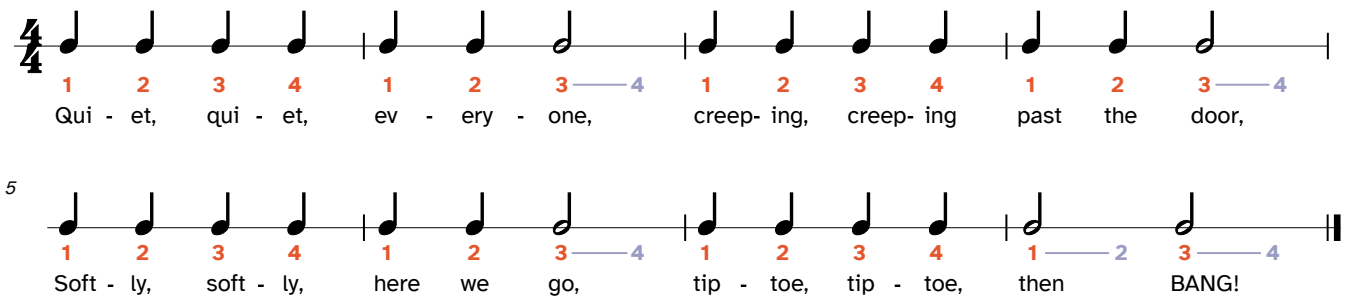
**Bottom 4:** a crotchet is one beat.

**THE NOTES**

**crotchet: walk** — 1 beat ●

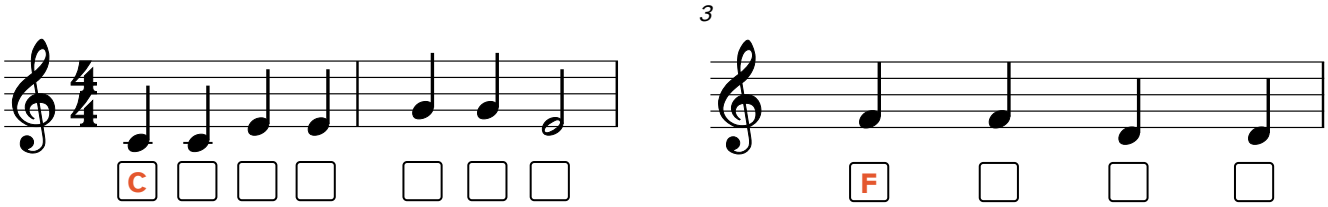
**crotchet rest: knock** — 1 beat ●

**minim: hold** — 2 beats ●●




## THE NOTES

Write each letter. ♯ in front: the black key just to the right. Write F♯.




**SPOT THE MISTAKE** Your teacher plays F for F♯, or loud for soft. Put up your hand when you hear it.

☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped it** ☐ **Wrote the letters** ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

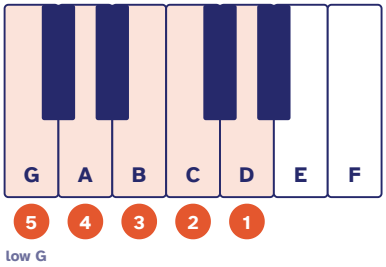
# 3 The roots

Today the left hand moves to the G position and stays there for the whole song.

## MEET THE ROOTS

5 on the low G, 1 on D. The roots: C is 2, D is 1, G is 5.

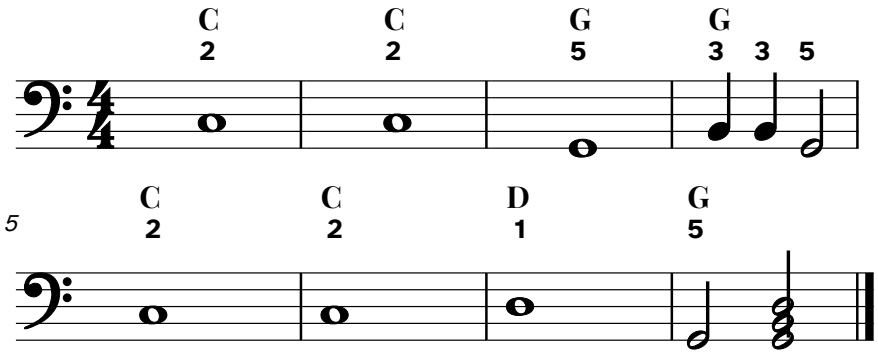
### LEFT HAND · THE G POSITION, LOW G TO D




**C:** 2.
**D:** 1, the thumb.
**G:** 5, the little finger.

## THE ROOTS, WITH THEIR NAMES

The left hand's part on its own: the roots, the answer in bar 4, and the BANG.




## PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Play each bar's root and hold it while the band plays the tune.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| C | C | G | G |
| C | C | D | G |

### 4 · CHECK

**I can play it: colour a step each time you climb**

| | Slowly | Steady | With the band | Fast |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **From the notes** | | | | |
| **From the names** | | | | |

TEACHER ☐ **Pass** ☐ **Not yet**

# + More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

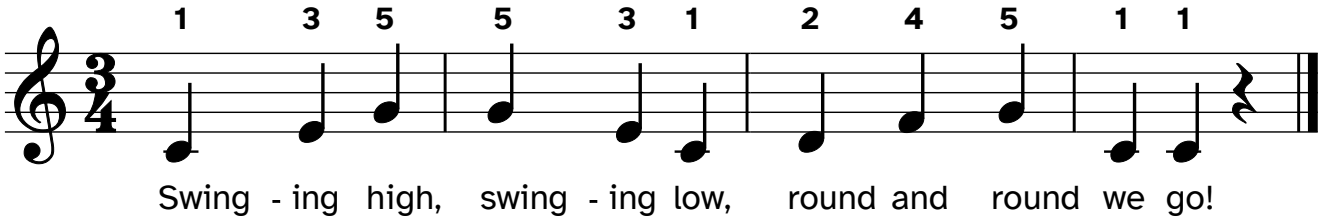
## SNEAKY CAT

Tiptoe music: 4 slides onto the black key and back, like a cat creeping.




## SWING SONG

A peek at Lesson 10: three beats in a bar. Lean on beat 1, like a swing.




## MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **The other way round: very soft first, then soft**
- ☐ **Two bangs at the end**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

## 5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand alone, soft and very soft
3. Both hands, with the band
4. Your choice: a tune from this page

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Sneaky Cat** ☐ **Played Swing Song**